

Question:

A 17-year-old teenager is brought to the emergency department with severe bleeding from his right hand. He was involved in a gang fight about 30 minutes ago where he received a penetrating stab wound by a sharp knife in the region of the ‘anatomical snuffbox’. A vascular surgeon is called in for consultation. Damage to which artery is most likely responsible for his excessive bleeding?

Answer Choices:

- A. Radial artery
- B. Ulnar artery
- C. Princeps pollicis artery
- D. Brachial artery

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

- The 'anatomical snuffbox' is a region in the hand located between the extensor pollicis longus and brevis tendons on the back of the hand.
- The radial artery runs through this region.
- The ulnar artery is medial to the wrist and not in the snuffbox.
- The princeps pollicis artery is a branch of the radial artery and not the main artery.
- The brachial artery is in the upper arm, not in the hand.
- Therefore, the most likely artery to be damaged, given the location of the wound, is the radial artery.
- The vascular surgeon would be called to repair the radial artery if it were damaged.

</think><answer>A. Radial artery</answer>

